The above then was the whole of paragraph 7 of the statement that was meant to be formally presented before the sessions court. Not only was this removed from the rest of the statement, but paragraph 8 was too. ‘This is our ideal,’ Bhagat Singh had here said and continued with the declaration, ‘Revolution is the inalienable right of mankind. Freedom is the imprescriptable birth-right of all. The labourer is the real sustainer of society. The Sovereignty of the people is the ultimate destiny of the workers.’[11] With thunderous effect Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt then ended their statement with the acclaim, ‘To the altar of this revolution we have brought our youth as incense, for no sacrifice is too great for so magnificent a cause.’[12] These words shed light on why it is that Bhagat Singh is described by the Indians of his homeland as a ‘shaheed’ (a martyr) because he was prepared to die for his beliefs. But ultimately, however, his aim as a revolutionary was to spread the idea of revolution amongst the masses. This is also clear from forty typed leaflets that both he and B.K. Dutt threw into the Delhi Central Assembly after the bombs had exploded. These had been written by Bhagat Singh himself according to Shiv Verma, who was another one of his comrades, in their Sitaram Bazaar hideout, and they were subsequently published in full by the *Hindustan Times*, on the same day of 8 April 1929.[13] In these he explains, ‘We want to emphasise the lesson often repeated by history that it is easy to kill the individuals, but you cannot kill the ideas.’ He continues, ‘Great empires crumbled but the ideas survived. Bourbons and Czars fell while the revolution marched ahead triumphantly.’

How clear, however, was Bhagat Singh about the ideas he was fighting for? He was strikingly clear. Few leaders of India who succeeded the Raj after Independence were as clear. In his homeland, ‘producers or the labourers, in spite of being the most necessary element of society are robbed by the exploiters of the fruits of their labour and deprived of their elementary rights’. These words were not going to be music to the government’s ears. On the other hand, they were milk and honey for the oppressed poor and went straight to the heart of the common man. In both India and Pakistan, they still do. The expunged statement spoke of how ‘the peasant who grows corn for all starves with this family; the weaver who